

China Daily Brief

Friday, September 25, 2026

2,698 words · 11 min read

RE: Xi's DC visit: truce extended, Taiwan pressed · China-Iran intel link · Manila-Beijing SCS clash · F-35 parts probe

USD/CNY
6.7037
▲ +0.09%

SSE COMPOSITE
3,888.37
▼ -0.60%

HANG SENG
24,510.09
▼ -0.97%

BRENT
\$98.86
▼ -1.47%

IN THIS ISSUE [Top Stories](#) · [US-China](#) · [The World](#) · [Beijing](#) · [Markets](#) · [Statements](#) · [Analysis](#) · [Overnight](#) · [The Wire](#) · [Upcoming](#)

• TODAY AT A GLANCE

- 1 Xi Jinping made his first Washington visit in over a decade, pressing Trump to 'oppose' Taiwan independence while the two sides extended their tariff truce by two months.
- 2 CNN reports Chinese intelligence and satellite imagery have helped Iran improve missile targeting against US forces and shipping in the Strait of Hormuz.
- 3 The Philippines accused China of obstructing a resupply mission in the South China Sea the same day the Pentagon confirmed it is investigating how stealth F-35 components reached Hong Kong.

DIPLOMACY

Xi and Trump meet at White House, extend tariff truce two months

Xi Jinping made his first visit to Washington in more than a decade, greeted by **Donald Trump** with a red-carpet ceremony and a White House state dinner on Sept 24. Xi said the two countries 'must coexist in peace,' and Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent said the sides agreed to extend their tariff truce by two months, while Trump said there were no moves toward joint AI guardrails.

FT, BLOOMBERG, BBC

CROSS-STRAIT

Xi presses Trump to 'oppose' Taiwan independence

Xi Jinping pressed **Donald Trump** to 'oppose' Taiwan independence during their Sept 24 White House meeting, while Trump separately praised China as a World War II ally, the Japan Times reported. Taiwan's government accused Xi of 'distorting facts' about the exchange, per Reuters.

BLOOMBERG, JAPAN TIMES, REUTERS

INDO-PACIFIC

Philippines accuses China of obstructing resupply mission

The Philippines accused China of obstructing a resupply mission in the South China Sea on Sept 25, Reuters reported, without further detail on the location or vessels involved. China's Coast Guard separately issued a spokesperson statement the same day, per Chinese defense ministry channels, though its content was not disclosed in available reporting.

REUTERS

US-CHINA

Chinese intelligence aids Iran's improved targeting of US forces

Satellite imagery and intelligence support from Chinese groups has helped Iran threaten shipping in the Strait of Hormuz and strike US military bases with improved precision, according to a series of US intelligence assessments described to CNN by four sources. The assessments point to a 'dramatic improvement' in Iranian targeting capabilities over the past several months.

CNN

SANCTIONS

Trump administration presses China on suspected nuclear tests

The Trump administration has pressed China in confidential talks over suspected nuclear weapons tests, the Wall Street Journal reported, citing people familiar with the matter. The report did not specify test sites, dates, or China's response in the available summary.

TECHNOLOGY

Pentagon probes how China got F-35 stealth parts via Hong Kong

The Pentagon's F-35 Joint Program Office confirmed a 'shipment issue' after stealth-coated cockpit-canopy and weapons-bay-door components from an Australian F-35 went missing en route to the US for repair in late May and ended up in Hong Kong. Lockheed Martin supplied the radar-absorbing-coated parts; the Chinese government has taken possession and not returned them, and Australian Defence Minister Richard Marles acknowledged the diversion.

TAIPEI TIMES

TECHNOLOGY Chinese automakers roll out 5-minute ultrafast EV charging · AP China

Chinese automakers are rolling out EV models with five-minute ultrafast charging times, AP reports, outpacing rivals in a closely watched race. The advance underscores China's growing lead in battery and charging infrastructure even as Western automakers work to catch up.

DIPLOMACY Families of missing Ukrainians await answers a month after Nepal-China floods · AP China

A month after deadly floods struck the Nepal-China border area, families of missing Ukrainian nationals are still awaiting answers, AP reports. The report gives no further detail on how the Ukrainians came to be in the flood zone or on the search's status.

DIPLOMACY China's first lady turns soft power on US audience · Reuters China

China's first lady Peng Liyuan is deploying cultural soft-power outreach aimed at a US audience during the state visit, Reuters reports, without detailing the specific programming involved. The effort parallels a separate joint museum outing this week with First Lady Melania Trump.

TECHNOLOGY China fuels rush to turn AI video into an industry · Reuters China

China is fueling a rapid buildout of AI-generated video as a standalone industry, Reuters reports, with domestic platforms racing to commercialize the technology ahead of global rivals. The report does not name specific companies, funding figures, or timelines in the available summary.

TECHNOLOGY Suzuki aims to halve development time to keep pace with China · Nikkei Asia China

Japan's Suzuki Motor said Friday it aims to cut new-model development time in half to keep pace with rapid changes in the auto industry driven by Chinese competitors, Nikkei Asia reports. The company did not disclose a specific timeline for the change in the available summary.

SOCIETY China's kids rank near the top in global school tests · Economist China

Chinese schoolchildren rank near the top of global school test rankings, according to the Economist, though the report does not specify which international assessment or subject areas are referenced. The finding adds to comparative data on China's education system's international standing.

DIPLOMACY In China, summit seen as projecting the country's rise · AP China

Domestic Chinese audiences are viewing the Trump-Xi summit primarily as a projection of the country's rising global stature, AP reports from Beijing. The framing contrasts with US commentary describing the encounter as heavy on symbolism but light on substantive breakthroughs.

EXPORT CONTROLS · WAPO CHINA

Rare earths give China a powerful hand heading into summit

China holds a 'powerful hand' in rare-earth and critical-mineral supply chains heading into the Trump-Xi summit, the Washington Post reports. The report does not detail new leverage points beyond continued US and allied dependence on Chinese processing capacity.

EXPORT CONTROLS · REUTERS CHINA

US, Japan discussed China's yttrium curbs ahead of summit

US and Japanese officials discussed China's yttrium export curbs ahead of the Trump-Xi summit, according to a document reviewed by Reuters. The document does not indicate whether the curbs were raised directly in the leaders' talks.

INVESTMENT · NYT CHINA

Xi's delegation arrives without a Chinese CEO entourage

American chief executives turned out in force to see **Xi Jinping**, while Chinese executives were largely absent from his delegation, the New York Times reports. The contrast points to how drastically business-to-business ties between the two countries have changed since Xi's last Washington visit.

DIPLOMACY · BLOOMBERG CHINA

Trump says no moves toward US-China AI guardrails

Donald Trump said there were 'no moves toward' joint US-China AI safety guardrails during the summit, Bloomberg reported. Beijing's MOFA separately declined to confirm whether it had agreed to a hotline mechanism that Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent said the two sides had established for AI safety incidents.

SANCTIONS · REUTERS CHINA

Firms linked to sanctioned Chinese cotton giant still sell clothes to US

Reuters identified firms linked to a sanctioned Chinese cotton producer that continue shipping clothing into the US market, per an exclusive investigation. The report does not name the specific US retailers or brands involved in the available summary.

CONGRESS · REUTERS CHINA

US senators delay permanent Chinese car ban effort

US senators have delayed action on legislation to permanently ban Chinese-made cars from the US market, Reuters reported. The report does not specify the reason for the delay or a new timeline.

DIPLOMACY · REUTERS CHINA

US airlines oppose China's bid for more flights

US airlines are opposing a Chinese bid to add more flights between the two countries, Reuters reported. The dispute centers on air-service rights amid broader US-China commercial tensions.

TARIFF · BBC ASIA (DIRECT)

BBC: summit delivered a two-month truce extension, little else

BBC's Laura Bicker reported the two leaders 'committed to a two month extension of the tariff truce' but delivered 'few big movements' on substantive issues. The report cited Xi's panda pledge as one of the visit's few concrete deliverables.

CROSS-STRAIT · REUTERS CHINA

Taiwan accuses Xi of 'distorting facts' after summit remarks

Taiwan's government accused **Xi Jinping** of 'distorting facts' after he pressed Trump to oppose Taiwan independence during their White House meeting, Reuters reported. Taipei did not detail the specific distortion beyond general pushback on Xi's framing of the island's status.

CROSS-STRAIT · TAIPEI TIMES

Taiwan upgrades Pratas Islands patrol capacity

Taiwan's Coast Guard Administration said its patrol capacity around the **Pratas Islands** has been 'comprehensively upgraded,' including a newly stationed 100-tonne-class patrol boat after a wharf project completed in July. The upgrade responds to increased Chinese coast guard patrols near the islands, the most recent of which occurred earlier this month.

JAPAN · KYODO CHINA

Japan's Takaichi declines comment on US-China summit

Japanese Prime Minister **Sanae Takaichi** declined to comment when asked about the Trump-Xi summit, Kyodo reported. The non-answer came as Tokyo continues to calibrate its own China posture separately from Washington's approach.

MIDDLE EAST · CNBC CHINA

Iran says it's up to US to end war as China presses de-escalation

Iran said Friday it is up to the US to end their war, CNBC reported, as China separately pressed for de-escalation. The comments came amid a new wave of Houthi missile and drone attacks on Saudi targets.

EUROPE · REUTERS CHINA

German auto lobby warns of China trade imbalances

Germany's auto industry lobby warned of growing trade imbalances with China and backed a WTO-based policy response, Reuters reported. The report does not detail specific figures cited by the lobby.

EUROPE · REUTERS CHINA

EU urges Britain to raise tariffs on Chinese cars

The EU urged Britain to raise tariffs on Chinese-made cars, according to the Financial Times as cited by Reuters. The report does not specify a proposed tariff rate or timeline.

INDIA · NIKKEI ASIA CHINA

India's solar makers face cell shortage amid China hurdles

India's small and midsize solar manufacturers are grappling with an acute cell shortage even as the country pushes to build supply chains independent of China, Nikkei Asia reports. The shortage highlights continued Indian reliance on Chinese-made solar cells despite localization efforts.

ASEAN · BLOOMBERG CHINA

Thai exports surge most in four years on AI, China demand

Thailand's exports surged at their fastest pace in four years, driven by AI-related and China demand, Bloomberg reported. The report does not break out the exact growth figure in the available summary.

620%

H1 2026 profit surge at Chinese chipmakers CXMT, SMIC

Nikkei Asia reports combined earnings at Chinese memory and foundry chipmakers grew more than sixfold in the first half of 2026, driven by AI demand and state investment.

Nikkei Asia China

• ECONOMY & BUSINESS

AUTO · BLOOMBERG CHINA

China's global EV exports rise 33% to 284,622 in August

China's global EV exports rose 33 percent year-on-year to 284,622 units in August, Bloomberg reported, citing trade data.

TECH / CXMT, SMIC · NIKKEI ASIA CHINA

CXMT, SMIC power 620% surge in chip industry profits

Earnings at Chinese chipmakers CXMT and SMIC grew more than 620 percent in the first half of 2026, buoyed by AI demand and national investment, Nikkei Asia reports.

FINANCE / HSBC, HANG SENG BANK · FT CHINA

HSBC axes \$26,000 members'-club perk for HK bankers

HSBC eliminated a \$26,000 members'-club perk for Hong Kong bankers as part of a benefits overhaul aligning pay structures with Hang Seng Bank staff, the Financial Times reported.

AUTO · NIKKEI ASIA CHINA

China's auto industry reaches consolidation tipping point

A tie-up between two major Chinese state-owned carmakers has raised the prospect of broader industry consolidation, Nikkei Asia reports, without naming the companies involved.

MACRO · CNBC CHINA

Survey finds 'surprise' jump in China's US orders ahead of summit

A private survey found a 'surprise' rebound in China's exports to the US ahead of the Trump-Xi summit, as companies position for continued trade stability, CNBC reported.

MACRO · BLOOMBERG CHINA

China shuns costly Brazil soybeans ahead of summit

China is shunning costlier Brazilian soybeans ahead of the Trump-Xi summit, Bloomberg reported, as Beijing positions for potential purchases from US farmers under the tariff truce.

● WHAT BEIJING DID

STATE COUNCIL + MINISTRIES · FRIDAY, SEPTEMBER 25, 2026

国务院 · STATE COUNCIL · *Li Qiang, Premier*

Signs revised Audit Law implementing regulations

Premier Li Qiang signed a State Council order publishing revised implementing regulations for China's Audit Law; specific provisions were not detailed in available reporting.

→ [State Council ZH ↗](#)

国务院/国家林业和草原局 · STATE COUNCIL / NATIONAL FORESTRY AND GRASSLAND
ADMINISTRATION · *unspecified*

Confirms two pandas will be sent to Zoo Atlanta

China confirmed giant pandas Pingping and Fushuang will be sent to Zoo Atlanta following Xi Jinping's announcement during the state visit.

→ [State Council ZH ↗](#)

国防部/中国海警局 · MND / CHINA COAST GUARD · *unspecified, Coast Guard spokesperson*

Issues statement amid Philippine resupply mission dispute

China Coast Guard's spokesperson issued a statement Sept 25 the same day the Philippines accused China of obstructing a resupply mission in the South China Sea; specific content was not detailed in available reporting.

→ [MND ZH ↗](#)

习近平 · XI JINPING · US-CHINA COEXISTENCE AND AVOIDING CONFLICT

CONCILIATORY · TO US

Xi Jinping ¹ · President of the People's Republic of China

“China and the US, as two great powers, benefit from cooperation and are harmed by confrontation; both sides must hold the bottom line of no conflict, no confrontation, and can find the right way for two major countries to coexist on this planet.”

中美两个大国合则两利、斗则俱伤...中美双方必须守住不冲突、不对抗的底线，也一定能走出一条两个大国在这个星球上的正确相处之道。

Delivered during Xi's welcome banquet toast at the White House on Sept 24, his first visit to Washington in over a decade.

解放军报 (PLA Daily ZH)

外交部 · MOFA · AI SAFETY DIALOGUE MECHANISM WITH THE US

ROUTINE · TO US

Guo Jiakun ¹ · MOFA spokesperson

“Per MOFA spokesperson: asked whether China had agreed to a US-proposed AI-safety emergency hotline, the ministry said reporters should 'ask the competent authorities.’”

建议询问主管部门

Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent said the two sides had agreed to a formal communication mechanism including an AI-safety incident hotline; MOFA would not confirm the claim.

外交部发言人 (MOFA presser ZH)

外交部 · MOFA · US-IRAN WAR DE-ESCALATION

CONCILIATORY · TO OTHER

MOFA spokesperson ¹ · MOFA spokesperson

“Per MOFA: prolonging the US-Iran war does not serve the common interests of the parties involved or the international community.”

美伊战事延宕不符合当事方和国际社会共同利益

Response to Iran's President Pezeshkian's UN General Assembly remarks, amid continued US-Iran conflict and Iranian proposals to reopen the Strait of Hormuz.

外交部发言人 (MOFA presser ZH)

外交部 · MOFA · RESPONSE TO NEW ZEALAND ALLEGATIONS

FIRM · TO OTHER

MOFA spokesperson ¹ · MOFA spokesperson

“Per MOFA: China urges relevant New Zealand institutions to stop spreading lies and creating conflict.”

中方敦促新西兰有关机构停止散布谎言、制造矛盾

Statement issued Sept 24 amid an unspecified dispute with New Zealand institutions; further details were not provided in available reporting.

• WHAT OTHERS ARE SAYING

TAIPEI TIMES · SEP 25, 2026

Matt Pottinger · Foundation for Defense of Democracies China Program chair

“peace through strength is essential to maintaining Taiwan's freedom and prosperity”

Pottinger delivered the closing keynote at the Resilient Taiwan for Sustainable Democracy International Forum and met President Lai in Taipei, his fourth visit since Lai took office in 2024.

[source](#)

TAIPEI TIMES · SEP 25, 2026

William Lai (Lai Ching-te) · President of Taiwan

“When authoritarianism seeks to spread fear, democratic societies should spread confidence through resilience”

Lai made the remark while meeting Pottinger at the Presidential Office, referencing the second annual Whole-of-Society Defense Resilience Committee forum held the prior week.

[source](#)

PEOPLE'S DAILY · SEP 25, 2026

Zhao Suisheng · Director, US-China Cooperation Center, University of Denver

“The two heads of state maintaining direct communication and enhancing mutual understanding is of great significance for properly handling differences and maintaining stable relations”

Zhao's comment appeared in a People's Daily roundup of US and Chinese figures' reactions to the Sept 24 Xi-Trump meeting.

[source](#)

PEOPLE'S DAILY · SEP 25, 2026

Robert Lawrence Kuhn · Chairman, Kuhn Foundation

“Predictability itself is a kind of global public good”

Kuhn's comment was part of the same People's Daily roundup of reactions to the Xi-Trump meeting.

[source](#)

DIPLOMACY

CNBC CHINA

Xi revives panda diplomacy, pledges pandas to Atlanta

Xi announced two giant pandas will move to Zoo Atlanta within days, reviving a decades-old Chinese diplomatic tradition, per CNBC.

WAP0 CHINA

State dinner guest list includes Musk, Altman

The White House released a state-dinner guest list including Elon Musk and Sam Altman among tech executives honoring Xi, per WaPo.

AP CHINA

Trump lays out pomp for Xi, says little on tensions

Trump offered Xi lavish red-carpet treatment while saying little publicly about unresolved US-China tensions, AP reports.

WAP0 CHINA

Survey finds Americans' views of China have warmed

A new survey finds Americans' views of China have warmed ahead of the Trump-Xi summit, WaPo reports.

AP CHINA

Melania Trump, Peng Liyuan tour museum together

Melania Trump and Peng Liyuan toured a museum together, a joint outing scrutinized for diplomatic symbolism, per AP.

TECHNOLOGY

WAP0 CHINA

How China is conquering high-tech markets once controlled by the West

China is capturing high-tech markets once dominated by Western firms, WaPo reports, without detailing specific sectors in the available summary.

CROSS-STRAIT

TAIPEI TIMES

Prosecutors seek 2-year terms for Chinese men who crossed strait illegally

Taiwan prosecutors sought two-year sentences for two Chinese men who crossed the strait illegally by rubber dinghy in July.

TAIPEI TIMES

Taiwan thanks eight countries for Taiwan Strait status-quo statement

Taiwan's Foreign Minister Lin Chia-lung thanked eight countries for a joint statement opposing unilateral change to the Taiwan Strait status quo issued at the UN General Assembly.

● UPCOMING

Oct
1

PRC National Day, 77th anniversary

Annual national holiday; watch for any linked military or diplomatic signaling.

Oct
25

UN Resolution 2758, 55th anniversary

A contested-interpretation flashpoint over Taiwan's UN status, following this week's allied statement on the Taiwan Strait status quo.

Nov
3

US midterm elections

China policy positioning by both parties likely to sharpen in the run-up.

Nov
10

Busan-deal suspensions approach lapse

The one-year suspensions of the BIS Affiliates ('50%') Rule and China's Oct 2025 rare-earth export controls are due to lapse around this date unless extended.

Nov
18

APEC Leaders' Meeting, Shenzhen

China hosts; Trump attendance and any follow-up Trump-Xi meeting to be confirmed.

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